TOP
FLOOR

written by
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an ambitious manhattan **doorman**
---
moves into the **penthouse** of his dreams
---
only to be **trapped** in a dangerous new identity

Open on the Pyramid House.

22 luxury stories over a manicured slice of Manhattan. This late, most lights are out. Except two penthouses up top.

And a green marble lobby down below.

Out front, a parked sedan faces away from the building.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Two skeptical eyes monitor the Pyramid through the mirrors.

SERA (PRE-LAP)
Murry's made mistakes.

SERA (30s) squeezes a juicebox in her mouth, splattering RED on her sweatpants. She checks the backseat for wetwipes.

SERA (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
But he wouldn't do this.

IN THE REARVIEW MIRROR

A <u>BODY DROPS</u> from the top of the Pyramid and--

SPLATS onto the street.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - HOURS LATER

REVEAL Sera sitting uncomfortably, in stained sweatpants.

SERA (CONT'D)
It's not who he is.

Across a table, two DETECTIVES exchange a look.

SERA (CONT'D)
I want to see him. Now.

Sera rises in a huff.

DETECTIVE 2
You will. But we need your help first. When were you with him last?

But she doesn't leave. Just grabs her tote bag. Digs in: Goldfish, no. Applesauce, fine.

SERA
Two weeks ago.

She struggles to open the package...pulling and stretching...

DETECTIVE 2
And? Where was he two weeks ago?

SERA
Two weeks ago, he was still living in my basement.

...until finally RIPPING it open. She exhales.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BASEMENT - DAY (TWO WEEKS EARLIER)

MURRY (24) lies face-first on the concrete floor.

SERA (V.O.)(CONT'D)
But things were looking up.

He raises himself into a pushup. By his side, an Android phone plays "MORNING PUSH - UNLEASH POTENTIAL".

SERA (V.O.)(CONT'D)
I guess they always were. That's what you need to understand about my brother. He never got "down".

He flattens again, dense beard dripping sweat.

WORKOUT VIDEO
Now rise again and hold.

He pushes up, leaving a face-shaped sweat-stain on the floor.

WORKOUT VIDEO (CONT'D)
Eyes to the sky.

Cranes his neck to the ceiling. Sees a CRACK OF LIGHT.

SERA (V.O.)
Not since before Murry was even Murry.

The room seems to SHAKE--

SERA (V.O.)(CONT'D)
Not since Murry was still--

And a voice from upstairs:

SERA (O.S.)
MURAT!

sends him FLOPPING onto the concrete.

Murry looks up the stairs at the:

KITCHEN

where Sera's yelling down at him.

SERA (CONT'D)
You better be dressed!

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Don't talk to him like that.

Her HUSBAND counsels in a preschooly tone while feeding their TODDLER, as if to impart a lesson. Sera mock-mimics him:

SERA
How else am I supposed to talk?

HUSBAND
With respect.

SERA
Respect the NJ Transit schedule.

MURRY (O.S.)
I have 16 minutes.

Murry emerges in a doorman uniform. Pours powder into a glass of water. Stirs. Chugs...as Sera suppresses her judgment.

SERA
I'll drive you to the station.

MURRY
I walk in 11.

SERA
You still need to eat.

MURRY
I'm on a mineral fast.

He pops an earbud in and heads out. She shouts after:

SERA
Those people aren't doctors! And
don't be late tonight!
(under breath)
He listens to anything anyone says.

Husband discreetly mouths to the Toddler: "not anyone".

INT./EXT. NJ TRANSIT - DAY

Murry stands all the way to Manhattan. Letting others take the seats. A testosterone-fueled podcast in his ear:

PODCAST (EARBUD)
The person you want to be is the person you are now. Your job is to find the difference and act, before the door of opportunity closes.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Murry opens the door for wealthy, mostly elderly residents. No one really looks at him. But he always smiles. Genuinely.

HOURS LATER

Murry heads to the elevator. Presses UP as he shouts:

MURRY
Barry, I'm on break!

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

DING! Murry steps off softly. Checks both ways. Then unlocks:

PENTHOUSE B

BARK BARK as Murry slips inside.

SNACKS (12, blind but limber) is going crazy. Barking and spinning. Sniffing Murry, investigating him...until Murry pours a bowl of food. As Snacks digs in...

...he inspects luxurious details: mounted speakers, a working fireplace, and an oak-framed oil painting of Icarus's wings.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Murry waltzes out through glass french doors.

The deck, shared with Penthouse A, is split by hedges. The view, straight to the park, is spectacular. But Murry isn't looking at the city below his feet...

...he's filling a SYRINGE with clear liquid.

TITLE:

TOP
FLOOR

He flicks the needle.

An air bubble rises...escaping into the sky.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Murry steps off the elevator...

BARRY (O.S.)
That's 16 minutes, Murry. PTO doesn't start until Monday.

...right into burly building manager BARRY - who sniffs.

BARRY (CONT'D)
And what's this smell?

Murry proudly presents his wrist as they walk.

MURRY
Do you like it?

BARRY
It doesn't matter if I like it. All scent profiles must be Board approved. On-skin *or* in-home. You know this. It's in the binder.

MURRY
But Juju has the binder.

BARRY
And many residents have allergies.

MURRY
So do you like it or not?

BARRY
This is about safety. Not the--
(sniff)
Fuzzy peach with a splash of--
(sniff)
Jasmine?

Murry smiles. He *does* like it! Then he SNIFFS. Oh no.

MURRY
Is that--

BARRY
Your problem tonight.

Murry looks at his watch: 5:00pm.

MURRY
But I have a dinner thing at 7.

BARRY
And I have a note from my doctor.

Murry takes a breath and proceeds alone to the:

FRONT DESK

where CYNTHIA of 21C holds a casserole of dubious content. She's springy for eight decades, but wields an ivory cane.

CYNTHIA
Made your favorite, Murphy.

MURRY
That's so sweet, Ms. Wax. But maybe Barry wants some too?

CYNTHIA
Barry brought a note.

Cynthia points to the casserole: *go ahead.*

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Poor thing's been complaining about his system for weeks now. I referred him to Ross Flicker...

Murry peeks at the clock as he takes the fork, then watches helplessly as Cynthia settles on a guest bench...

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
...you know Ross. Or maybe he was before your time. Excellent GI but quite *uncooperative. The man wore flip-flops to a board meeting...*

...and unloads a full clip of grievances. There are no breaths or pauses for Murry to say he has to go. It's a shellshocked haze of complaints and casserole until--

DING!

Murry sprints to the door in anticipation of:

VALERIE of PENTHOUSE A emerging from the elevator.

But the vivacious 55-year-old stops to look down on Cynthia, who's 25 years her senior, but lives one floor below.

VALERIE
What are you feeding this poor boy?

CYNTHIA
It's called "casserole", Valerie. I always forget you never had a family to cook for.

VALERIE
I mean his shift ended 40 minutes ago. What are you droning on about?
(turning to Murry)
Let me guess: the new recovery center for at-risk teens.

Cynthia plants her cane in the floor and rises with fury.

CYNTHIA
It's a literal drugstore by our home. *We're* the ones at risk!

Valerie's delighted she took the bait.

VALERIE
Cynthia. It's their home too.

CYNTHIA
Oh shove it in your NPR tote bag. Those "kids" are not from here. They could be dangerous.

VALERIE
Please. The only dangerous people in this neighborhood are upstairs.

The Co-Op Co-Presidents lock eyes. Two grizzled veterans of uptown real estate wars. Murry can taste the tension. And it tastes like Cynthia's casserole.

Suddenly, they both start LAUGHING. Loudly.

Unsure what to do, Murry laughs too. Fear in his eyes.

HA HA HA HA

THE <u>DOOR OPENS</u>!

On its own! That's not supposed to happen! Murry races over, but not before--

An <u>elegant shadow of a man</u> spreads over the lobby floor.

VALERIE
Nikki.

CYNTHIA
Nikos.

This is NIK of PENTHOUSE B.

MURRY
Sorry, Mr. Lamb.

Though we can't see his face yet. Just a graceful wave that puts Murry at ease. But not Cynthia.

CYNTHIA
I assume you've gotten our emails.
(pointing cane at Nik)
And don't you dare blame this on "spam" again. I know that's baloney.

VALERIE
Cynthia. This is hardly the venue.

CYNTHIA
Excuse me. I am President of this Co-Op Board--

VALERIE
Co-President. And I insist we save this discussion for our next meeting. He's clearly busy anyway.

CYNTHIA
Busy with what?

NIK (O.S.)
Murry.

Murry looks up to Nik. He always has.

NIK (O.S.)
Do you have something for me?

HALLWAY

Murry carries a delivery box, trailing Nik's tailored jacket.

NIK (O.S.)
Shouldn't Juju be here by now?

Murry balances the box, then knocks on the door to the:

STAFF OFFICE

where night doorman JUJU is playing games on his phone.

MURRY (O.S.)
Juju, I'm leaving!

ELEVATOR

Doors open. Murry follows Nik inside.

NIK (O.S.)
Nice haircut by the way.

Murry touches his hair, touched he noticed. And for the first time today, someone looks Murry right in the face, revealing:

Nik's face. His haircut almost exactly the same as Murry's.

In fact, the two bear a striking resemblance.

Doors close. The two men rise together.

PENTHOUSE B

Snacks sniffs excitedly at Nik's feet.

NIK
Thanks again for the help with Snacks today. How was everything?

Murry sets down the delivery box. But stays in the hallway.

MURRY
Two cups Purina, 12 units insulin. And no one saw me come or go.

Murry gently intercepts Snacks before he can venture out.

NIK
You don't need to be so sneaky.

MURRY
Barry told me a doorman got fired for being in a unit unattended.

NIK
Well I'm here now. Why don't you come inside for a bit?

Murry looks at his feet. The line between the hall and the unit. It was one thing when he was alone. But with Nik actually here, it feels more...intimate.

NIK
Come on. I've had a hell of a week. You're not in a rush, are you?

BUZZ. Murry quickly ignores a call from Sera. He is.

MURRY
Not at all.

Murry steps inside.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT

Murry follows Nik to the edge of the deck. He takes in the view, leaning forward on a railing - which CREAKS.

NIK
Careful. Long way down from here.

Nik stares straight down at the asphalt. Something's wrong.

MURRY
Are you okay, Mr. Lamb?

NIK
You know, you're the only one who ever genuinely asks me that?
(off his surprise)
I mean it, Murry. People say "how are you doing" without so much as a question mark. But you...

Nik trails off. Murry opens to ask, but Nik gets there first:

NIK (CONT'D)
I'm fine. It's just work.

MURRY
I never asked what you did.

NIK
But you know.

Silence. But Nik SLAPS his back, LAUGHS. Leads him inside.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - CONTINUOUS

Nik pours two glasses of Ouzo. Hands one to Murry.

NIK
The money business may seem sexy. But I'm just another middle man.

MURRY
This doesn't look like the middle.

NIK
Well I guess our appetites rise as we get older.

Nik drops back on the sofa with Snacks. Sips his ouzo. Gestures for Murry to sit, which he does.

MURRY
Please. You're not that old. We look basically the same age.

NIK
That's very sweet of you, Murry. But it's just the money. Creams, sun, doctors. It's all a facade.
(turning to TV)
But I see how we might be mixed up.

Side by side in the TV's warped reflection, the two men are nearly indistinguishable.

NIK (CONT'D)
You're like me with a fresh start.

Sigh. The liquor's loosening him up. But his glass is empty.

He shakes the ice. Murry hands over his drink.

MURRY
You can have mine. I'm avoiding neurotoxins until I'm post-revenue.

NIK
Post-revenue? They don't pay you to be a doorman here?

MURRY
Well. I'm not a doorman. I'm an entrepreneur who opens doors.

NIK
(curious smirk)
You have a company?

MURRY
I have a pitch.

NIK
Then let's hear it!

Nik slaps Murry's leg. Finishes his drink. Murry lights up--

NIK (CONT'D)
Unless you need to be somewhere?

--but so does his phone. He *does* need to be somewhere.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Sera's call goes straight to voicemail as she cooks.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
Who do you want to be?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Murry pitches to Nik.

MURRY (CONT'D)
How do you want to be known? There is one sensation tied most tightly to memory. To identity...
(pacing like he practiced)
Crafting a unique, non-fungible fragrance is more than just an investment in your *brand*. As a tradable asset, it's an investment in your *future*. So. Do you smell it?

Murry SPRITZES a bottle of fragrance in the air dramatically--

MURRY (CONT'D)
...the person you want to be?

--mist raining down on Nik. He COUGHS.

MURRY (CONT'D)
Sorry. That's a prototype. But you get the idea. Right?

NIK
Sure. It's like...*crypto cologne.* Very interesting.

MURRY
Really? You're interested?

NIK
No, Murry. In this context, "interesting" means *not interested.*

Murry mouths "interesting means not interested" to himself.

Nik gives him a look: *what was that?*

MURRY
I repeat things I want to remember until I can write them down.

NIK
And I love that hustle. I do. But--

Nik gestures for him to sit. Murry stays standing, but sinks.

NIK (CONT'D)
But it looks like you know where this is going.

MURRY
I want to hear it anyway.

NIK
Fine. This isn't Shark Tank. And I don't do Venture Capital...but--

But? Murry's posture snaps back into place.

NIK (CONT'D)
But. I know VC folks. And I suggest you orient the pitch *to them*. The thing is, when you raise money, you're not selling a product. You're selling a *vision of the world* only you can create. You understand?

Nik stands to pour himself another drink.

MURRY
Definitely. I'll be locked in on this for the next two weeks.

NIK
Two weeks?

MURRY
Yeah. I have PTO starting Monday.

Nik pauses. Holding the bottle. Like he's stuck.

MURRY
Is everything okay, Mr. Lamb?

NIK
Nik.

Murry cocks his head. What?

NIK (CONT'D)
It's Nik. And no. It's not.

Nik sighs deeply.

NIK (CONT'D)
Like I said, it's been a hell of a week. The market's been... *uncooperative*. And my clients are panicked. But they're scattered - S*anta Fe, Boca*. I need to see them. But, well, I can't leave Snacks.

The blind dog bumps into Murry's leg. Then nuzzles.

NIK (CONT'D)
He's a good dog. But he's not *well*. And it's not just the cataracts. The sitters always screw up his insulin. And those kennels and "dog hotels" won't even do the shots. But you, I can trust. And he trusts you too.

Eye contact. Nik is desperate. Snacks whimpers too.

NIK (CONT'D)
I wouldn't ask if it wasn't an emergency. I don't have any family. And I'll pay you, of course.

MURRY
And I'd love to help. Really. But my place doesn't allow pets.

NIK
Then stay here.

Murry blinks. What.

NIK (CONT'D)
You have two weeks off. What better place to focus on your business? And when I'm back, maybe I can connect you to some VC contacts.

Nik disappears into the bathroom...

...leaving Murry lost in a glorious daydream.

INSERT - visions of lounging in the penthouse, working on his fragrances, and signing a deal on the dining room table.

NIK (O.S.)
So. What do you think?

BACK TO REALITY - Murry walks into the dining room table. Ow. He rubs his thigh.

MURRY
I think I could lose my job.

NIK (O.S.)
No one's losing their job.

MURRY
But eventually *someone* will see me.

Nik finally returns with a <u>RAZOR</u>.

NIK
Not if they see me.

What. Nik waits for this to land.

Murry sputters, turns to his reflection in a wall mirror.

NIK (O.S.)
Of course, we notice a difference. Because we see our faces more than anyone. But I'm sorry to tell you--

Nik appears beside him in the mirror. He's older. And shaved.

NIK (CONT'D)
No one else looks at you like that. Not in this city.
(beat)
We're all just *shapes and shades* to each other.

They are roughly the same shape and shade. Though Murry's bulkier, and that's accentuated by the beard.

NIK
Think about it. Do any of the tenants ever even look at you?

MURRY
You do. And Cynthia stares above my head sometimes when she's talking.

NIK
She's nearly blind *with* glasses.

MURRY
What about Valerie? She hired me.

NIK
And she leaves for the Hamptons tonight. Until August.

Nik leans in for the final pitch:

NIK (CONT'D)
I know this sounds crazy. But it's a win-win. Maybe even a miracle, if you believe in that sort of thing. Two weeks could be enough to save my fund. And maybe it's enough for you to, like you said, *start being the person you want to be.* <u>This</u> is the place to do that. And <u>I</u> am the guy you want owing you one.
(beat)
Don't let fear hold you back.

But that's not what's holding him back. BUZZ BUZZ. It's Sera.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Murry walks into a frantic scene. A cooking Husband, crying Toddler...and an angry sister.

SERA
You are <u>very</u> late.

MURRY
Did you already finish dinner?

SERA
No. She's late. We're doing coffee.

MURRY
So why are you mad at *me*?

SERA
You said you'd be here.

MURRY
She's the one who's not here.

SERA
That is <u>not</u> the point.

The Husband GRINDS BEANS. Sera shouts over it:

SERA (CONT'D)
And those are <u>not</u> the right beans!

Sera SLAPS the counter with a spatula. Husband stops.

MURRY
None for me, please. I'm phasing out neurotoxins.

Sera trains the spatula on Murry, threateningly.

SERA
We haven't seen Fatma Teyze in six years. You will sit with that woman and drink hot liquid. I don't care what chemicals it contains.

The Husband throws a supportive arm over her shoulder.

HUSBAND
She's your aunt, Murry.

SERA
She's not our real aunt.

MURRY
She's not our real aunt.

DING DONG!

Sera slips her Husband's hand off her shoulder with the spatula. Points it to the door: *get it.*

LIVING ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Husband serves cookies to Sera, Murry, and FATMA (80s).

FATMA
Damadın çok efendi.

SERA
She says you're very polite.

HUSBAND
I know what she said.
(pleased, to Fatma)
Afiyet olsun, Fatma Teyze.

(Note**: bolded dialogue** = translated Turkish for subtitles)

FATMA
I'm surprised you still live here.

SERA
She's surprised we still live here.

FATMA
I thought a big shot writer like you would stay in the city.

Sera bites a dry cookie.

MURRY
What did she say?

FATMA
He doesn't speak Turkish?

SERA
That's what he says.

MURRY
What did you say?

SERA
She's surprised we still live here.

MURRY
You already said that.

FATMA
Your aunt must hate the new design.

SERA
Um. She said real Teyze must have complained about our redesign.

HUSBAND
She died before we did it.

SERA
I know. Give me a second.
(thinking, then to Fatma)
Teyze died before we moved in.

FATMA
But she never left.

Before Sera can finish scowling, the KETTLE WHISTLES!

COFFEE TIME

They sip tiny coffee cups. Murry finishes in one swig, spits it in another cup. Fatma flinches — disturbed but intrigued.

FATMA
Let me read you.

SERA
No. Thanks, Fatma Teyze.

HUSBAND
Let her do it. It's fun.

SERA
It's witchcraft.

MURRY
Just translate.

Fatma inspects the patterns of the coffee in Murry's cup.

FATMA
Oh yes, Murat. We still talk about you back home. *The boy who climbed out of the earth*.
(then to Sera)
Does he even remember?

SERA
He says he doesn't.

Murry nudges her. Before Sera can translate:

FATMA
But you do, of course. Guilt is such a loathsome burden.

Sera clenches her teeth. Fatma turns back to Murry and the cup, tracing a jagged line of grounds from bottom to top.

FATMA (CONT'D)
He has much ahead of him. But he must be careful not to fall. Miracles don't happen twice.

Murry nudges Sera again. But she's thrown off. She stammers:

SERA
She's talking about the shapes.

MURRY
It looks like an arrow.

SERA
Or maybe it's a Pyramid. Like the building where you work.

FATMA
It will open only once.

SERA
She says be patient at work and good things will happen.

MURRY
What did she actually say?

FATMA
The door, Murat.

SERA
It's a door. You're a doorman--

MURRY
I'm not a doorman. I'm an--

MURRY (CONT'D)
--entrepreneur currently opening doors.

SERA
--entrepreneur currently opening doors.

Her mockery hits him right in the gut. Which turns to anger.

MURRY
Why won't you tell me the truth?

SERA
It's not "the truth", Murry. It's the imagination of an 80 year old woman who believes in ghosts!

Sera rises fast, KNOCKING the cup to the floor.

Murry and Sera march out. Fatma stares at a BLACK STAIN on the carpet - shaped like a downward triangle. The Husband doesn't understand what's going on, but tries to be polite.

HUSBAND
Basketbol sever misin?

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - DRIVEWAY - A LITTLE LATER

BOUNCE BOUNCE

Husband plays basketball with the Toddler and Fatma. It goes as you would imagine. But he's really trying!

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BASEMENT - SAME

BOUNCE BOUNCE

Above Murry's head, outside narrow windows: feet dance on asphalt around a bouncing ball.

But he's not watching. He's tinkering with fragrances.

Gloves on, he removes a sample bottle from a large box labeled FLAMMABLE. Tests it on his skin. SNIFF.

CREAK--

Murry hides the box under a blanket. Rips off the gloves and pretends to meditate as--

SERA (O.S.)
I need to do laundry.

Sera clomps down the stairs without clothes. Eyes on her Husband's happy feet through the window.

SERA
He’s like a Labrador.

MURRY
Contentment is wisdom, Sera.

SERA
Don’t do that.
(off his look)
Don’t regurgitate podcast tidbits at me like some elevated yogi.

MURRY
I wouldn’t if you ever listened to any of the episodes I send you.

BOUNCE. They pull back. She resets the tone as she tidies.

SERA
Listen. I know you’ve been working hard at...*being realistic*. And I know this isn’t your dre--
(looking at pullout sofa)
--dream. But if you keep saving, I really think you can have the whole energy drink thing paid off in--

She TRIPS over a bundle of hard blankets.

SERA (CONT'D)
What the fuck is this?

She unveils the box labeled <u>FLAMMABLE</u>. Murry rushes over to check on the bottles inside.

MURRY
Expensive. Careful.

SERA
This is what you’re spending your money on? Cheap plastic bullshit that’ll set the house on fire?

MURRY
It’s fragrance.

SERA
It smells like--
(sniffing bottle)
Bullshit! There’s nothing in here.

MURRY
That’s just the base. Members customize their own unique blend.

Sera blinks. Speechless. Murry senses an opening...

MURRY (CONT'D)
Do you want to hear the pitch?

BOUNCE. No!

SERA
You promised you'd focus on work.

MURRY
This is work. I have two weeks PTO to stand up the business.

SERA
Business? It's another fucking pyramid scheme. And I can't believe I even have to say this, but Murry: you are not the one at the top.

MURRY
You have no idea what you're talking about. This is my concept. Nobody's taking advantage of me.

SERA
Yet.

BOUNCE.

SERA (CONT'D)
But this is what always happens. Someone sees that big stupid smile on your face...they feed your dreams, then leave you holding the bag. That's what happened with the Georgian yogurt guys. That's what happened at the shore. And that's what *just* happened at Rutgers.

BOUNCE.

MURRY
This is nothing like Rutgers.

SERA
Yes. It is. It's always the same.

BOUNCE bounce bounce into a dribble...

SERA (CONT'D)
You're always the same.

...and rolls into the basement window.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER THAT NIGHT

Sera can't sleep. She pours a glass of water. But doesn't drink. Just cracks the basement door...

SERA
Murry?

No response. She closes the door. Then she checks MESSAGES from Murry on her phone. Mostly podcast links from him. She opens "ACTIVATE AGENCY". But she doesn't even have the app.

NIK (PRE-LAP)
Murry...

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Foamy beard hair covers the sink.

NIK (O.S.)(CONT'D)
What'd I tell you?

A HAND wipes steam off the mirror, exposing:

Murry, freshly shaven.

NIK (O.S.)(CONT'D)
You're a miracle.

Another HAND wipes the rest of the mirror, revealing:

Nik beside him. Without the beard, the two are a close match. Except for Murry's broad shoulders and Nik's age/exhaustion.

NIK (CONT'D)
My clothes might be snug. So treat yourself to something nice.

He sets down a black credit card. Heads out.

NIK (O.S.)(CONT'D)
Can't wait to hear that new and improved pitch when I'm back.

LIVING ROOM

Nik finishes packing a bag and speaks loudly:

NIK (CONT'D)
In the meantime, just stick to his schedule and don't drop any food. He'll eat anything off the floor.

Snacks sniffs at Murry's suitcase and box of fragrances.

On top, Nik finds Murry's wallet.

Inside: the driver's license of Murat Oğan. Longer hair, bushy beard.

MATCH CUT TO:

MURRY'S SHAVEN FACE

in the bathroom mirror. Major difference from the license.

NIK (O.S.)
Be sure to try the glasses.

Murry puts on glasses. They blur the world a bit.

With the slight blur, he looks <u>almost exactly like Nik</u>.

NIK (O.S.)
And Nik?

MURRY
Yeah?

NIK (O.S.)
That was a test. Good job.

He hears the ZIP of Nik's bag.

NIK (O.S.)(CONT'D)
I owe you my life.

Murry rinses out the sink and scurries to the:

LIVING ROOM

where he heads toward the door to say goodbye.

MURRY
See you in two weeks.

He stretches his hand out to shake Nik's.

But the door is closed.

He pulls off the glasses and sees:

A mirror on the back.

He's <u>looking at himself</u>.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sera shouts downstairs as her Husband feeds their Toddler.

SERA
Murry! Get up!

HUSBAND
He didn't tell you?

Sera whips back to him. *Tell me what?*

BEDROOM

Sera whisper-screams at her Husband as he makes the bed.

SERA
What do you mean he "found a place"? He doesn't have any money.

HUSBAND
Maybe he has a friend.

SERA
You didn't think to ask?

HUSBAND
At 2am? I'm just trying to support--

SERA
Why can't you support *me*?

HUSBAND
This <u>is</u> supporting you, Sera. He's 24. You can't baby him forever.

SERA
I can if he acts like a baby. Our toddler shows better judgment.

HUSBAND
Can you please just find something else to focus on besides him?

SERA
I'm not bored. I have a child.

HUSBAND
And a husband who now works from home. Plus, we have my mom--

HUSBAND (CONT'D)
(off her scowl)
For emergencies. I just don't think it's the worst idea to have some type of...project to work on.

SERA
Like what, *baking bread*?

HUSBAND
Sera. You're a writer.
(off her grinding teeth)
Because you don't write.

SERA
You sound like Murry.

HUSBAND
At least he knows who he is.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
Nikos C. Lamb.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - DAY

Murry practices Nik's voice in the mirror.

MURRY (CONT'D)
But you can call me Nik.

With blurry glasses on: it's a perfect match. Without them: razor bumps cover his face. And Nik's sweater stretches at the seams on his shoulders, like a hand-me-down.

Snacks WHINES by the door.

MURRY
Relax, buddy. He'll be back in a few weeks.

Murry thinks. Then heads to the bathroom...

...returns with Nik's cologne. SPRITZ.

Snacks scampers over. SNIFFS. Then WHINES again. *Nice try.*

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Juju opens the door for Murry and Snacks as they return from a walk. Juju gives him a respectful nod. Murry flushes with excitement. It's working!

ELEVATOR

Murry hits PH with pleasure. As the doors close...

AN IVORY CANE pierces the gap. DOORS POP BACK OPEN--

CYNTHIA steps in with a scowl. Taps 21.

Doors close. And they rise together in silence...

...until she SNIFFS. Murry freezes.

DING! Doors open.

CYNTHIA
No need for so much cologne, Nikos.
(stepping off)
We can all smell the desperation.

DOORS CLOSE on his woozy face. Snacks whines. *That was close.*

PENTHOUSE B

Murry tinkers with a new formulation labeled “Nik”. Snacks SNIFFS. Doesn’t approve. Hm.

MURRY
I’ll need to go downtown to get different oils. You’ll be alright?

INT. STORE - DAY

Murry shops for essential oils. Sniffing thoughtfully.

BUZZ. Text message from SERA: “Where are you?”. Ignores it.

EXT. DOWNTOWN STREET - DAY

Bag in hand, Murry passes a brick building. Tiny sign reads: VILLAGE HOUSE. The logo matches a key fob on Nik’s keychain.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - DAY

A RECEPTIONIST at the front desk SNIFFS.

RECEPTIONIST
What is that? Is there a gas leak?

MURRY (O.S.)
Hello?

Finally, she notices:

Murry standing oddly at the end of the desk. Face covered in razor bumps. Clothes ill-fitting. Bag of mysterious bottles.

RECEPTIONIST
Hello. Hi. Um. Are you a guest? The club is members-only.

MURRY
I am a member. Nikos Lamb.
(raising key fob)
Do I just tap here?

He taps a READER - GREEN LIGHT. Receptionist half nods.

RECEPTIONIST
I'll just need to see some ID.

Just then, a MEMBER emerges from the door, taps his key fob to a reader, and walks right in.

RECEPTIONIST (CONT'D)
Do you have your driver's license?

DING! A group emerges from the elevator across the lobby.

WENDY (O.S.)
Murry?

Murry freezes. Then bolts outside as a...

...woman his age, WENDY, emerges. Looking around. Confused.

INT. PYRAMID - ELEVATOR - DAY

Murry ignores a call from Sera. Hits PH. Doors close until...

FIVE RED FINGERNAILS slip between. Doors pop back open for:

Valerie dragging her luggage onto the elevator.

VALERIE
Afternoon, Nikki.

Doors close on his startled face. *Not again.* They go up.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
You look surprised to see me.

MURRY
Oh no. Um. I just thought you were in the Hamptons.

VALERIE
There’s a gas leak. I started seeing things. And the smell!

She SNIFFS. Murry goes white. But--

DING!

...she steps off and heads to Penthouse A without a word.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry gets Nik’s voicemail. Before he can leave a message--

KNOCK!

Murry hangs up. Checks the peephole. No one’s there.

But Snacks BARKS toward the glass door to the deck, where:

Valerie waits outside. Shit. Murry scurries to open up.

VALERIE
What a day. Do you have wine?

She blows past him to the wine fridge. Inspects bottles. Murry chases behind. Before he can stammer out a response:

VALERIE
What year is this one?

MURRY
(checking label)
Oh. Um. 2022?

VALERIE
Good. Nothing he’ll miss.

MURRY
Who?

VALERIE
Nik.

Murry cocks his head. *Yes?*

VALERIE (CONT'D)
I didn’t know you could read without your glasses.

Valerie UNCORKS the bottle.

Murry goes still. She inspects his silent face.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Otherwise, it’s uncanny. Have you two always looked this similar?

MURRY
Please don’t fire me.

VALERIE
Settle down. We all know whose idea this really was. And I suppose I’m supposed to be at the beach?

MURRY
I’ll tell him to come back.

He pulls out his phone, but she plucks it from his hand.

VALERIE
Don’t make *me* the party pooper. This all seems like a lot of fun.

MURRY
You’re not mad?

VALERIE
Mad? Murry, I’m worse than mad.
(gesticulating, spilling)
I’m bored! *This city in the summer.* It’s municipal dramamine, darling. And this little game of ‘Guess Who’ is titillating! Look at my arm!

Valerie holds up goose bumps on her surprisingly toned arm.

MURRY
I’m just taking care of the dog.

VALERIE
And taking care of yourself.

Her fingers trace the stitching on his sweater, being stretched tightly over his broad chest.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
But eventually something will finally snap. Those poor fibers.
(heading for the door)
Come on, Saks closes at 9.

MURRY
Why are we going to Saks?

VALERIE
Because they know us at Neiman's.

INT. SAKS - MEN'S SECTION - LATER

Murry holds up an obnoxious sweater for Valerie's review.

VALERIE
Absolutely not.

MURRY
But it's Gucci.

VALERIE
It's garbage, darling.
(ripping it away)
Wealth is a language. And these logos are practically screaming.

DRESSING ROOM - LATER

Murry peels the curtain to reveal a new outfit to Valerie.

VALERIE
Now we're talking. You're like a whole new man.

Murry pulls out Nik's credit card, but she pushes it away.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Oh no. This is my treat. It's so fun dressing you up. Like my doll.

MURRY
(Nik voice)
More like an action figure.

Valerie LAUGHS way too loud. Looks at her goose bumps. Then she steps inside the dressing room.

VALERIE
This is thrilling, Murry. Or should I call you Nik?

She closes the curtain behind her.

EXT. VILLAGE HOUSE - NIGHT

Murry looks in a window's reflection. Sees his smooth face. Well-fitted clothes. Then sniffs himself. He can do this.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - NIGHT

Murry swipes his key fob, marches right inside...until:

RECEPTIONIST (O.S.)
Mr. Lamb?

Murry stops. Shit.

RECEPTIONIST (CONT'D)
Just be careful. The floor is wet.

FIREPLACE - LATER

Murry "reads a book". But really, he watches people around him. How they sit. How they drink. How they laugh.

Inside his "book", YouTube plays on his phone: "BEAR MARKET MAVEN: Buying the Dip". Earbud in ear.

WENDY (O.S.)
Murry?

The petite but powerful WENDY (his age) appears on his flank. He's happy to see her. Just...um...*speechless*.

WENDY (CONT'D)
It's Wendy Win. Rutgers? I thought I saw you here the other day.

BAR - A FEW MINUTES LATER

Murry drinks club soda. Wendy pounds a cocktail and bar nuts.

WENDY (CONT'D)
So what are you up to these days? Davis said you were a doorman?

MURRY
That's so funny. Davis is great.

WENDY
So you're *not* a doorman?

Murry shakes his head. Wendy smirks. Murry squints: what?

WENDY (CONT'D)
Nothing. It's just, you don't care that Davis made that up about you?

MURRY
I control what I can control.

WENDY
You really haven't changed.
(laughing to self)

WENDY (CONT'D)
I was actually just thinking about what you said after that whole probiotic energy drink thing.
(Murry voice)
"You can never really know if a choice is right or wrong. All you can do is make it right."
(catching herself)
Sorry, I shouldn't bring that up.

MURRY
It's fine. It's cool. The best entrepreneurs don't finish college. And I channeled those lessons into my new business model.

WENDY
Cool. So what's the business?

What. He's not ready for that. He flushes red.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Relax. If it's good enough for us to steal, you're doing great.

MURRY
Us?

WENDY
Yeah. I'm at Pearson Danowitz?

Murry CHOKES on his club soda.

WENDY (CONT'D)
The VC firm.

MURRY
I know. Yeah. That's cool. Um. But I shouldn't talk about it. It's um, it's in...*stealth mode.*

WENDY
Murry. I'm the stealthiest. Just take me up to 30 thousand feet.

MURRY
I've never flown that high.

She LAUGHS loud. Touches his arm. Giving him confidence.

MURRY (CONT'D)
Fine. It's simple: *non-fungible fragrances.* Custom crafted scents, tokenized and tradable on-chain.

MURRY (CONT'D)
(off silence)
I've been working on the phrasing. Is that high-level enough?

WENDY
Right at cruising altitude.

He's not sure if she's serious. She rises.

WENDY (CONT'D)
And it's interesting.

He sinks. He knows what this means.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Really. I just have to get to dinner. But let's connect. I have your number right?

She checks her phone. Got it. Then gives him a quick hug.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Good to see you, Murry. And good to see you're still...*Murry*.

On her way out, she texts "got something interesting".

SERA (PRE-LAP)
Murry.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Sera leaves a voicemail as she folds laundry.

SERA (CONT'D)
I just want to know where you are. If you're in trouble - even if it's money, I will help. And I won't be judgy. I promise. Please call me.

Meanwhile, her Toddler watches a nature show on TV.

NATURE SHOW (TV)
--by changing color, the cuttlefish can hide in plain sight, conserving energy for its singular task: protecting its young from danger.

Her Husband pokes his head in from the hall.

HUSBAND
Hey. Are you busy?

No. She's done folding. Just one more item: Murry's t-shirt.

SERA
Yes.
(loading a lie)
I'm meeting the girls. In the city.

CUTTLEFISH swim on TV.

MATCH CUT TO:

CUTTLEFISH

on Nik's TV. Snacks sprawled out in front of it.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - DAY

Murry, meanwhile, takes a bubble bath. He looks at a reflective ceiling. Sees his shaven face. Makes a bubble beard...then quickly wipes it off.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
What makes us *us*?

LIVING ROOM - LATER

Murry practices his pitch for Valerie.

MURRY (CONT'D)
As luxury goods become accessible, consumers are desperate for new and innovative ways to stand out--

RINGING from a phone.

VALERIE
Is that you?

He shakes his head. RINGING stops. He resets.

MURRY
But identity isn't static--

RINGING again. Valerie looks at the wall, it's her phone.

VALERIE
I'll call them back. Go ahead.

But before he can start again...KNOCK KNOCK!

Snacks BARKS at the door. Murry and Valerie exchange a look.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
Nikos! We know you're in there.

Fuck. Murry races to the peephole. Oh no.

He turns back to Valerie. But she's already gone.

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK as Cynthia yells:

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Open up!

Behind her: the rest of the CO-OP BOARD. Except one...

VALERIE (O.S.)
What's going on here?

...until Valerie pokes her head out from Penthouse A.

CYNTHIA
There you are. I've been calling you. Emergency Board meeting. Now.
(whispering)
We're ambushing him, Valerie.
(slipping key into door)
This is an ambush.

PENTHOUSE B

LOCK JIGGLES. Murry desperately calls Nik. Not answering.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
This is the Co-Op Board. We have commandeered the master key under Article 4 of our charter, granting access in cases of emergency or suspected criminality.

Cynthia opens the door and marches right in...

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
And <u>you</u>, Nikos, have been acting like a god damn criminal.

...trailed by RHONDA (80) and LARRY (90s, motorized chair)...

...and Valerie who mouths to Murry: "I had no idea".

VALERIE
We can handle this like adults.

CYNTHIA
He’s the one avoiding us.

Valerie secretly mimes a cough. Murry COUGHS.

MURRY
I’ve just been really sick--

CYNTHIA
No rescheduling now. Rhonda already bought bagels.

RHONDA
I only have two everything.

Rhonda holds up a bag to Murry but Cynthia snatches it away.

CYNTHIA
He gets nothing.

VALERIE
(staring at Murry)
Why doesn’t he get us plates?

KITCHEN - MOMENTS LATER

Murry gets Nik’s voicemail again as Valerie scurries in.

VALERIE
I had no idea this was happening.

MURRY
What is happening?

VALERIE
Some on the Board believe Nikki is...mismanaging our money.

MURRY
Wait. *You’re* his clients too?

VALERIE
Of course. He runs the Co-Op fund. But recently, he’s been...evasive.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
What’s taking so long?

VALERIE
He’s making coffee!

MURRY
You have to get them to leave.

VALERIE
I can't. That crusty spider has every right to invoke Article 4. But it's not like she knows anything about finance. She just wants to make Nik dance...
(grabbing hips, swaying)
...so let's dance for her, Nikki.

LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Valerie sets down the plates as the Board selects bagels.

CYNTHIA
No spreads?

RHONDA
There's cream cheese.

CYNTHIA
That's basically a condiment. This is a luxury building.

VALERIE
You don't eat it anyway.

CYNTHIA
I want the option. And don't you think Larry deserves a little lox?

They turn to the legendary Larry in his motorized wheelchair. But he doesn't say a word. He never does.

VALERIE
Larry likes whitefish, but the doctors worry he'll choke. You'd know that if you ever talked to him.

RHONDA
Can I use the bathroom first?

Murry hustles in with a carafe full of coffee. And we're off.

CYNTHIA
Just take the damn minutes, Rhonda.
(BANGING cane on floor)
Calling this emergency meeting to order. Present with the Board today is Nikos Lamb of Penthouse B and manager of the Cooperative Investment Fund. I'll begin by formally requesting our now past due quarterly statements.

Murry gulps. He's in too deep. But--

VALERIE
Can I just ask a question first?

He quietly exhales, relieved.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
What the hell are you doing Nikos?

He flinches. Valerie charges full steam ahead.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
We trusted you. We urged everyone in the building to give you their hard-earned savings. And now you think you can--
(to Rhonda)
What did your niece call it?

RHONDA
Ghosting.

VALERIE
You think you can just *ghost* us?
(before he can respond)
I don't want to hear your excuses. You have two weeks to get us those statements. Or we're going to have to get our attorneys involved. Do you understand?

Murry nods solemnly.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Then I'm satisfied. Larry's tired. We'll reconvene when we have the facts. In two weeks.

Larry doesn't say a word. Cynthia sneers at Murry.

CYNTHIA
Nothing to say for yourself?

VALERIE
He's sick, Cynthia.

CYNTHIA
Why won't you let him speak?

MURRY
There's not much to say.

Valerie shakes her head. Stop speaking! But it's too late.

CYNTHIA
What happened to your voice?

MURRY
I'm sick, *Cynthia*.

The sharp tone cuts through the room. Valerie nods: *proceed*.

MURRY (CONT'D)
But the portfolio is healthy. I'll walk you through all the details in two weeks. For now, I just need you to be patient.

CYNTHIA
You know I'm not a patient woman.

MURRY
And that will cost you.

CYNTHIA
Excuse me?

Valerie shoots him a look: *what are you doing?*

MURRY
I mean the market rewards patience. Fear is what's expensive. Remember: you're being paid to tolerate risk.

Valerie smirks. But gestures to wrap it up.

MURRY (CONT'D)
And I'm being paid to be aggressive and opportunistic. If you can't tolerate that, take the points on your savings account. And take the bagels. I don't eat white bread.

Valerie secretly smiles. Cynthia openly scowls.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - A FEW MINUTES LATER

Murry exhales outside as Valerie skips over from Penthouse A.

VALERIE
You did it! That was so exciting. Look at my arm!

Valerie displays proud goosebumps. Sees his dour face.

VALERIE
What's wrong?

MURRY
You hate me!

VALERIE
Oh dear, it's not personal.
(touching his face)
It's just *Manhattan*. It'd be suspicious if I wasn't harsh with Nikki in front of them.

MURRY
Because he's a criminal.

VALERIE
Criminal? *Please*. That sounds so pedestrian. Nik is more...in the middle. And I'll tell you a secret: most of the people up here are dabbling in *some sort* of gray area.

Valerie reviews adjacent penthouses around the deck.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Really. I spent 35 years as an auditor before I sold the firm. I know every trick in the book.

MURRY
I didn't know you had a company.

VALERIE
Of course. I climbed my way up here with my own bare hands.

MURRY
You were never married?

VALERIE
I had a husband.
(looking down on street)
But he was of limited utility.

She turns back to Murry. Adjusts his collar lovingly.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
You, though, have certainly proven your worth. Nik is lucky to have you, whether he deserves it or not. He'll be happy when he gets home.

MURRY
But do you think helping cover for him makes me a bad person?

VALERIE
Bad person? Darling, *he's* the bad person. You're a better Nik than Nik ever was. If anyone's earned a life like this, it's you.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

RING! Murry scrambles in, shirt off. Answers Nik's call.

MURRY
Nik. I was just going to call you--

NIK (PHONE)
I know. Rhonda emailed the minutes.

MURRY
I was ambushed.

NIK (PHONE)
You could have run away.

Murry sinks. He knows.

NIK (PHONE)(CONT'D)
But you stepped up. You saved the day. Where did you learn so much about asset management?

MURRY
YouTube.

NIK (PHONE)
Impressive. And much appreciated. You just bought me two more weeks to get everything sorted out.

MURRY
Wait. So you're not coming back?

NIK (PHONE)
Do you want me to?

Murry looks around the penthouse. Then at Snacks. He sits slowly on the sofa. No.

NIK (PHONE)
Listen. I'm sorry about all this. Those fusty old house cats just don't understand how the jungle really works. I'm not the man they think I am. My business is just...*complicated*.

NIK (PHONE) (CONT'D)
But this'll blow over. I promise. Still, if you need me to come home--

MURRY
No. It's okay. I can stay.

NIK (PHONE)
Really? You're sure?

MURRY
Yes. Anything else I can help with?

NIK (PHONE)
Yes, actually. Do you know a place downtown called the Village House?

Oh no. Did they call him about Murry going there?

NIK (PHONE)(CONT'D)
Well I prepay a monthly tab and it expires tomorrow. No rollovers. Why don't you head down there and make sure it doesn't go to waste?

MURRY
I think I can handle that.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Nik talks to Murry on a bench, framed by Manhattan towers.

NIK (CONT'D)
I know you can, Nikki.

His new beard is growing nicely.

A CAR DRIVES BY

Inside, Sera peeks at the man. Can't see his face.

She pulls down the street. Parks.

Behind her in the rearview: The Pyramid.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - NIGHT

DING! Looking fine, Murry steps off the elevator and hears:

SERA (O.S.)
Murry. He's my brother.

OH NO. He turns around and presses DOWN. Hurry!

SERA (O.S.)(CONT'D)
Have you seen him?

FRONT DESK

Meanwhile, Barry deals with Sera.

BARRY
I thought he was on vacation. Is he in trouble or something?

SERA
Honestly, I don't know.
(nodding to guest divan)
Mind if I wait here for a bit?

BARRY
Yes.

BASEMENT

Murry gets off on the basement floor. Heads out back exit.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera jumps in her car. Huffs, annoyed.

Phone RINGS. It's Murry! She answers on speakerphone.

MURRY (PHONE)
Sera. You're going to get me in trouble at work.

SERA
So you answer Barney's calls and not mine?

MURRY (PHONE)
Barry is my manager. Technically. And I'm trying *not* to use my phone so I can fully focus.

SERA
Where?

INT./EXT. TAXI - SAME

Murry hops in a cab as he talks to Sera. Frustrated.

SERA (PHONE)(CONT'D)
Why won't you just tell me whose place you've been staying at?

MURRY
Is it so unbelievable that I got my own place?

SERA (PHONE)
Yes. You don't have any money.

Insulted, Murry puffs up as the car drives. *Should he lie?*

MURRY
I actually have a new investor.

SERA (PHONE)
In the *body spray?*

MURRY
It's custom fragrance!

A FIRETRUCK WAILS by the taxi.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera hears the FIRETRUCK WAILING before he hangs up.

He must be close. Hm.

Texts Husband: "going to be late tonight." Looks at it. Deletes the period. Sends.

In the rearview mirror: Barry opens the door for <u>a resident</u>.

But Sera ignores it.

She's waiting for Murry.

RECEPTIONIST (PRE-LAP)
Welcome back, Mr. Lamb.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - SAME

A receptionist checks Nik's member ID on a screen.

<u>Murry</u> strolls inside. Pleased with himself.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Snacks sniffs TWO SHOES at the door.

But they march straight past him to the bedroom...

...leaving Snacks sniffing and confused for a few beats...

...until they return with a stuffed duffel bag and walk right back out the door. Snacks whimpers, unpet.

BASEMENT - A MINUTE LATER

DING! Two shoes step off the elevator, head through the basement - duffel bag dangling - out the back exit.

EXT. PYRAMID - BACK ALLEY - MINUTES LATER

Standing in the two shoes: a man buttons a doorman uniform.

He checks his reflection in a window:

It's Nik. Real Nik. But Bearded. Looking just like old Murry.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - RESTAURANT - SAME

Real Murry enjoys gnocchi and sparkling water.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera answers her Husband's call on speakerphone.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Where are you?

SERA
I told you. I'm with the girls.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
For six hours? You don't even like them. Are you following him?

SERA
What. I'm not following him.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Then where are you?

She quickly thinks of a story.

SERA
I'm working on a story.
(off a quiet gasp)
Don't be so surprised.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
No I'm just--

SERA
Don't say proud. What is it?

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Oh. Nothing. She's looking for her police costume. Or just the badge?

Sera looks under the seat and finds a TOY POLICE BADGE.

SERA
I thought she was the little mermaid.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
She's an undersea detective. Just - do you have it or not?

She sees a BEARDED MAN IN A DOORMAN UNIFORM walk inside.

She hangs up. Of course, she thinks it's:

JUJU (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

And she sits back to wait.

He has to come out eventually.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - SAME

Juju, now on his shift, opens for the bearded doorman: Nik.

JUJU (CONT'D)
What are you doing here? I thought you were still on vacation.

NIK
I just need my phone charger.

Nik races straight past him. Weird. But Juju shrugs it off.

21C

DING DONG!

Cynthia rises from bed. Checks the peephole at the door.

CYNTHIA
Murphy? Is everything okay?

The door SWINGS OPEN--

--right into her forehead.

Knocking her to the floor.

Nik steps over her as she bleeds and writhes in pain.

He finds a laptop. Plugs in a thumbdrive. Then gets to work.

As Cynthia moans on the floor, he copies excel files to the drive. Finishes quickly. She whimpers:

CYNTHIA
What are you doing?

NIK
Quitting.

He SNAPS the laptop closed. Yanks out the thumbdrive.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera sees the back of a well-dressed resident walking inside. But doesn't even register.

JUJU (PRE-LAP)
There he is, *Nikki Nik.*

She's still waiting for Murry to come out.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - SAME

But Murry's coming in, as Juju holds the door.

PENTHOUSE B

Snacks BARKS as Murry returns.

He gives Snacks the love Nik just withheld.

But the dog keeps BARKING toward the deck.

Murry turns to look.

Lit from inside, the glass door is reflective. In it he sees:

a bearded man in a doorman uniform.

He quickly shakes it off. It's just his imagination. But it's hard not to see. *He's going back down soon.*

BEDROOM

As Murry folds a sweater in the closet, he realizes his doorman uniform is gone.

BARK BARK

LIVING ROOM

Murry races back in, expecting to see someone.

MURRY
Is someone there?

But no one's there.

Just Snacks barking toward the glass door to the deck.

Like before, it's fully reflective.

So he kills the lights - revealing, on the other side:

Nik.

Bearded.

In the doorman uniform.

Murry SCREAMS.

Nik rushes inside. Finger to lips.

NIK
Shh. This isn't what it looks like.

Nik pockets the thumbdrive. Checks the wall with Penthouse A.

MURRY
What did you do?

Murry sees BLOOD on Nik's shoes. Then he notices Nik's beard.

And the nametag on the uniform.

MURRY (CONT'D)
What did I do?

He steps back in fear.

CREAK.

Snacks BARKS toward the deck again.

Someone's there.

NIK
Murry.
(whispering)
Do we have a guest?

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Valerie spies in the Penthouse B window.

But the light's off.

Can't see inside. Just a reflection of towers. Until:

NIK (O.S.)
You should have stayed in the Hamptons.

A doorman uniform appears behind her.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Murry hears a SCREAM from outside.

He SWINGS open the door and sees:

Nik grappling with Valerie by the edge of the deck.

VALERIE
Help!

Murry charges outside...

SERA (PRE-LAP)
Murry's made mistakes.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Two skeptical eyes monitor the Pyramid through the mirrors.

Sera squeezes a juicebox in her mouth, SPLATTERING RED on her sweatpants. She checks the backseat for wetwipes...

SERA (PRE-LAP)
But he wouldn't do this.

IN THE REARVIEW MIRROR

A BODY DROPS from the top of the Pyramid and--

SPLATS onto the street.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - HOURS LATER

REVEAL Sera sitting uncomfortably, in stained sweatpants.

SERA (CONT'D)
It’s not who he is.

Across a table, two Detectives exchange a look.

FRONT DESK - A LITTLE LATER

RINGING ends on Husband’s phone. He looks up at the DESK COP.

HUSBAND
She’s not answering.

DESK COP
And this is the mother?

HUSBAND
Sister.

DESK COP
Oh. *Her*. They picked her up at the scene.

What. The Cop checks the monitor.

DESK COP (CONT'D)
She’s heading back there to see him now.

HALLWAY

Detective 2 leads Sera through the precinct...

HUSBAND (V.O.)
What happened?

...along the holding cells...

DESK COP (V.O.)
We were hoping you could tell us.

...until they reach a heavy door into the:

MORGUE

Sera stands in the cold, steel room. Lights humming.

SERA
That's him.

On the gurney below her:

A blood-stained doorman uniform. Filled with the mush of a man who fell 300 feet. Face obliterated by asphalt.

DETECTIVE 2 (O.S.)
We can still do a quick DNA swab--

SERA
No. That's my brother. Murat Oğan.

She looks down. At the nametag.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Murry stares at his face in the mirror. His hand shaking.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
Our Murry?

EXT. PYRAMID - NIGHT

An NYPD SERGEANT briefs sobbing Valerie by the door. Street is dark. Quiet except for chatter and cleanup.

SERGEANT
The detectives will come by in the morning. I can't imagine--

VALERIE
No. You can't.

She starts sobbing louder. He puts a hand on her shoulder.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Well, I guess you can't keep the past buried forever.

SERGEANT
Buried? What was buried?

She gives him a look. Confused he doesn't already know.

VALERIE
Him.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
You told them about that?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - LATER

Murry cracks the bathroom door open to talk to Valerie.

VALERIE
It was in your immigration file. We saw it in the background check. But this is good - well, *not good*, but you get it. People hear *trauma* and *mental illness* and stop thinking. This explains what happened.

Murry looks in the mirror. What *did* happen?

SERA (PRE-LAP)
He wouldn't kill himself.

INT. NYPD - THAT NIGHT

Sera argues with Detective 1 outside the morgue.

DETECTIVE 1
You told us you were following him because you were worried.

SERA
Not about this.

DETECTIVE 1
Sera. People suffer in silence.

She hates that answer. But before she can blow--

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Sera! Are you okay?

Husband charges down the hall. Wraps her in a big hug.

SERA
Yeah. I just got here.

Husband knows she's lying, but keeps it to himself. He holds her tight. Then looks up at the Detectives.

HUSBAND
So. What happens now?

INT. PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Valerie steps into the bathroom. Closes the door.

VALERIE
Listen to me. You saved my life. And I will do anything to protect yours. Whichever you choose. But you need to choose. Right now. If Murry's not dead, then he killed Nik. Do you understand?

Murry turns to the mirror. Stiff. Valerie recalibrates.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
What am I thinking? This is insane.
(grabbing her head)
Call the police. Tell them you've been in shock. That's why you didn't report it right away. Then tell them the truth. Yes, you were impersonating him. But he was manipulating you! From the start. The walls were closing in on him - *we were closing in*. And <u>you</u> were his way out. He knew you'd do anything to get up here. And he pulled your strings like a puppet--

She opens the door but--

He pushes it closed.

MURRY
I'm not a puppet.

VALERIE
But Murry--

MURRY
Murry is dead.

Murry looks in the mirror. Breathes. Then opens the door.

MURRY (CONT'D)
We should get rid of his stuff.

CLOSET - A LITTLE LATER

Murry checks his box of fragrances.

VALERIE (O.S.)
Is that everything?

He covers it with a blanket as Valerie appears behind him.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
What about this?

She doesn’t see the box. Just pulls his phone from his back pocket. She’ll take care of it.

FIREPLACE ROARS

The doorman cap and Murry’s wallet melt in the embers.

Snacks SNIFFS at Murry’s feet. Flames illuminate his perfectly shaven face.

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK, BARK BARK

DETECTIVE 1 (PRE-LAP)
Mr. Lamb?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - MORNING

Snacks races to four new feet at the door.

DETECTIVE 1 (O.S.)(CONT’D)
Is now a good time? We’re speaking with all the tenants.

Murry welcomes in the Detectives with a graceful smile.

MURRY
And you’re starting at the top.

Then catches his reflection in the mirror: a moment of fear. He adjusts his facial expression. Then closes the door.

MURRY (CONT'D)
Coffee?

DETECTIVE 2
Do you have any tea?

Murry halts. He actually doesn’t know.

KITCHEN - A MINUTE LATER

Murry catches his breath. And recites his old affirmation: *“Be the person you want to be.”*

DETECTIVE 2 (O.S.)
What was that?

MURRY
Oh. Just looking for the tea!

LIVING ROOM

Murry returns with one coffee but no tea.

DETECTIVE 1
Let's just get started. So, Murry--

MURRY
Yes?

They set down a print-out of Murry's driver's license photo.

DETECTIVE 2
Did you see him last night?

As Murry sits, he studies the wild hair and a bushy beard. Looks nothing like the clean shaven man sitting here.

MURRY
I thought he was on vacation.

DETECTIVE 2
Right. But the cameras show him getting off on this floor.

Murry gulps. The Detective shifts in his chair.

DETECTIVE 2
Presumably to access stairs to the roof. Had he been acting strange?

MURRY
Definitely. Depressed, even.

DETECTIVE 1
We heard he was the chipper type.

MURRY
Well he was. That's what was so strange about it. Him being *down*.

DETECTIVE 2
So you knew him well.

MURRY
No. Not really. He walked my dog and gave him insulin sometimes.

DETECTIVE 1
But he's otherwise been...*normal*?

MURRY
(scratching Snacks's butt)
Basically. Though he'll eat absolutely anything off the ground.

DETECTIVE 2
Not the dog. *Murry.* Did you know him well or not?

Murry shakes his head too fast.

DETECTIVE 2
But you were close enough that you noticed a change in behavior.

Murry considers his angles. Hiding his panic.

MURRY
Was I supposed to?

He sees his reflection. Nik. Squares his shoulders.

MURRY (CONT'D)
The truth is: Murry wasn't a neighbor. He wasn't a friend. He was staff. *He* pays attention to *us*. Not the other way around.

The Detectives exchange a look. Then back at him.

DETECTIVE 2
So you *didn't* notice anything?

Murry shakes his head, firmly. Confident. Detective 2 holds eye contact for another beat...

DETECTIVE 1
Thanks for your time, Mr. Lamb.

...then closes his notebook. They rise.

As Murry exhales, Detective 2 stops at the door.

DETECTIVE 2
What about the money?

They both turn.

DETECTIVE 1
Right. Did you ever give Murry any money? Besides tips.

MURRY
Why else would I give Murry money?

DETECTIVE 1
You are an investor. Correct?
(off his nod)
Well apparently, Murry claimed to have an investor. In his business.

MURRY
You mean the *cologne*?

He looks at the closet where he hid the BOX OF FRAGRANCE.

They follow his eyes until HE LAUGHS, drawing them back.

MURRY
Sorry. I shouldn't laugh. Yes. Murry told me about his...*idea*. But that's not the kind of investment I do. This isn't Shark Tank.
(quiet gulp)
He hasn't been going around telling people I *invested* in him. Has he?

HUSBAND (PRE-LAP)
Investor? When did he say that?

INT./EXT. HUSBAND'S CAR - SAME

Sera rides shotgun as Husband drives.

SERA
Oh. Um. Just before he left.

He feels a lie. But lets it go. He has bigger fish.

HUSBAND
Sera. Why didn't you tell the detectives about Turkey?

SERA
What about Turkey?

HUSBAND
Sera--

SERA
Because that's all they'd need to know. Just drop me at my car.

HUSBAND
Fine. Where is it?

She prepares a lie. But they hit a light. She opens the door.

SERA
I can walk from here.

INT. PYRAMID - 21C - DAY

Valerie finds Cynthia, head-bandaged, in bed.

VALERIE
You should be in the hospital.

DR. FLICKER tends to her. Larry and Rhonda there in support.

DR. FLICKER
It's just a bump on the head.
She'll be fine with some rest.

VALERIE
Ross. You're a gastroenterologist.

RHONDA
I actually just read about the
brain-gut connection in the Times--

VALERIE
Then how about fetching some food?

Valerie makes harsh eye contact: leave. Rhonda quickly pushes Larry's chair out of the room.

CYNTHIA
I don't need any food.

Cynthia leans forward. Valerie pushes her right back down.

VALERIE
You need rest. And I need answers.
(sitting)
I'm concerned, Cynthia. An attack
on you is an attack on all of us.

CYNTHIA
They're still scooping him off the
street. He got what he deserved.

VALERIE
He didn't get anything else?

CYNTHIA
I don't know. I was on the floor.
(thinking, cautious)
But I think he was on my computer.

Valerie heads into the other room...

CYNTHIA
Hey. You can't just unplug that.

...returns with a big chunky laptop. Boots it up.

Valerie browses RECENT APPS. Finds: FIN-X.

VALERIE
Why do you have FIN-X installed?

CYNTHIA
It's an accounting program.

VALERIE
I have a CPA, Cynthia. I know what FIN-X is. Why is it on your laptop?

CYNTHIA
I'm Treasurer of the Co-Op Board.

VALERIE
That is a *ceremonial* position.

CYNTHIA
Not according to the National Board of Co-Op Board Treasurers.

Valerie squints. *What's that?* Cynthia beams with pride.

CYNTHIA
That's right. I was recruited by a charming local representative. He's the one who gave me that software.
(bragging)
For free. He even helped me link our accounts over the phone.

Valerie snaps the laptop closed. Steps to Cynthia.

VALERIE
You brainless invertebrate.

Valerie DROPS the heavy laptop on Cynthia's torso. OW!

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Don't you realize who that was?

DETECTIVE 1 (PRE-LAP)
Nikos Lamb. He goes by Nik.

INT./EXT. SQUAD CAR - DAY

Outside the Pyramid, the Detectives talk to Sera on speaker.

DETECTIVE 1 (CONT'D)
There are other investors and finance types in the building, but they’re all retirees.

SERA (PHONE)
And this guy really knew Murry?

DETECTIVE 2
They all knew Murry.

DETECTIVE 1
(holding him back, relax)
Yes, Murry helped him with his dog. But there’s no indication of a business relationship. We checked the bank records too.

SERA (PHONE)
I still want to talk to him.

DETECTIVE 2
(muting)
Is she fucking serious? We’ve already indulged her enough.

SERA (PHONE)
I’m going over there.

DETECTIVE 1
(quickly unmuting)
Absolutely not. This is an active investigation. Stay away from the Pyramid and do not harass any residents. We won’t warn you again.

INT./EXT. SERA’S CAR - SAME

Sera hides as she watches the Detectives drive off.

CALL ENDS. Her stereo automatically returns to a podcast:

PODCAST (STEREO)
--most of opportunities. But most people quit before they even try. And you’re not most people.

Sera looks out the window: where Murry fell.

INT. BANK - VAULT - DAY

PODCAST continues in Murry’s ear as he heads into the vault.

PODCAST (EARBUD)(CONT'D)
Don't just stare at the choice you made. Find a new choice to make.

Murry opens a safe deposit box. Finds the Co-Op ownership agreement...then Nik's birth certificate.

EXT. PYRAMID - DAY

Sera steps out of her car. Looks around the yellow police tape, where he fell.

Nearby: a storm drain. She spots a small plastic rectangle under the lip.

A thumbdrive. Sera looks at it. Then up at the roof.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

Sera jumps back in her car. Inspects the thumbdrive.

It's stamped with initials: NCL. Hm.

She grabs her phone, about to call the Detectives. Until--

KNOCK KNOCK at her window.

VALERIE (O.S.)
Can I help you?

Sera shakes her head without lowering the window for Valerie.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
I'm sorry. But I saw you poking around. This is a crime scene.

Sera thinks. Grabs her daughter's toy police badge. Holds it up against the window. Speaks loudly, confident:

SERA
I'm aware. Are you a resident?

VALERIE
I am Co-President of the Board.

Hm. Sera lowers the window.

SERA
So you know everyone here?

WENDY (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

INT. BANK - DAY

Wendy spots Murry walking out past the ATMs.

MURRY
Wendy. What are you doing here?

WENDY
This is where I kickbox.

MURRY
I didn't know you kickboxed.

WENDY
(are you dumb?)
I'm using the ATM. Are you okay?
I've been calling.

MURRY
Oh sorry. I lost my phone.

WENDY
Alright...*well*, I soft-pitched your idea to the deal team. And buddy, they are Capital-I *Intrigued*.

MURRY
Really? I barely told you anything.

WENDY
Exactly. Less is more with these guys. They hear the word *stealth* and immediately cream their chinos.

Ew.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Sorry, that's the culture. Any chance you have time to talk now?

Someone KNOCKS into him. His documents scatter on the floor.

Wendy drops to help. Tries not to look...then looks...sees a Cooperative Equity Agreement. Um.

WENDY
Dude. You <u>own</u> a place at the Pyramid? That condo down the block?

MURRY
It's technically a Co-Op.

WENDY
And technically your family's...?

MURRY
It’s mine. And it was great seeing you. But I need to take my dog out.

WENDY
You have a dog? Can I meet him?

Wendy grabs his arm before he can refuse.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - DAY

Valerie serves Sera tea and joins her on the sofa.

VALERIE
I don’t understand. What kind of business would Nik have with Murry?

Sera tries to remember what detectives sound like on TV.

SERA
Is it possible that Nik lent him money, or something of that nature?

VALERIE
No. I don’t think Nik would give Murry any money.

SERA
Why?

VALERIE
Because Nik isn’t the kind of investor who gives anyone anything. He’s the kind that takes it.
(sipping tea)
The man is a money manager.

SERA
You seem to know a lot about him.

VALERIE
He manages our money. The whole Co-Op investment fund. Not to mention, *Detective*, he lives next door.

BARK BARK from next door. Sera looks at the wall.

SERA
Is that him?

VALERIE
I don’t think so. That poor dog is blind. He tends to bark at ghosts.

Sera sees a small bathroom alongside the same wall.

SERA
Could I use your bathroom?

PENTHOUSE B

BARK BARK as Murry leads Wendy inside and meets Snacks.

MURRY
Let me get the samples.

BATHROOM

Sera listens through the wall. Hears muffled speaking. Hm. Then she opens the door...but...it's locked. She knocks.

SERA
Hello? Ms. Muller?

LIVING ROOM

Valerie holds a chair to the door. Fake BADGE in her hand.

VALERIE
Hello, *Officer Octopus*. Who are you and what are you doing here?

SERA (O.S.)
Let me out and I'll explain.

VALERIE
Explain it to the real police!

SERA (O.S.)
I'm Murry's sister!

Valerie releases the chair. Steps back. Sera opens the door.

SERA
I think Nik had something to do with my brother's death.

VALERIE
So what are you doing in my powder room!? Tell the detectives!

SERA
I did. They think I'm crazy.

Valerie snorts: *I wonder why.*

SERA (CONT'D)
I'm not crazy. Look.

She shows her the thumbdrive. It says NCL.

WENDY (PRE-LAP)
Nikos Casavetes Lamb.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry brings back the box. But doesn't see Wendy.

MURRY
Did you say something?

WENDY (O.S.)
Murry. Who is Nikos?

He turns and finds her reading Snacks's tag.

MURRY
Oh, *Nik*.
(fuck)
Yeah, he lived here. I sort of um *inherited* his dog when I took over the apartment.

WENDY
So why do you have his license?

Wendy drops his wallet. Her voice sharpens.

WENDY (CONT'D)
What the fuck is going on? Did you fake this identity to defraud investors or something? Were you going to fuck me? Were you going to fuck...*Pearson*?

MURRY
They have nothing to do with this.

WENDY
I told you: the deal team is *interested*. When you didn't answer my calls, they freaked out.

MURRY
Wait. So you followed me? They think my idea is that good?

WENDY
They think your idea is dogshit.

Wendy simmers. Murry's never seen the wolf in her before.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Exactly the type of dogshit morons like you spend money on. They wanted me to buy you out and license the concept in "less regulated markets".
(panic meeting anger)
Now, the partners are gonna find out I got hustled by some *delusional con man* who sleeps in his sister's basement!

MURRY
I sleep here! And Nik is not a fake identity or anything. He's real.

WENDY
Then where is he?

Murry has no response. Wendy's starting to get freaked out.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Where is he, Murry?

MURRY
He's um traveling. Indefinitely.

Snacks BARKS. Wendy sees on the mantle: a <u>photo of "Nik"</u> in front of a mountain. Murry's face...obviously photoshopped.

WENDY
Oh my god. What did you do?

She backs to the door.

MURRY
Nothing!

WENDY
Then where is he, Murry?

Murry can't spit out a response. Wendy grabs the door handle--

Murry grabs her hand.

MURRY
He's here.
(hands off and up)
He's me.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
That's us.

PENTHOUSE A

Next door, the THUMBDRIVE is plugged into Valerie's computer. On screen: financial documents. Accounts like 12E, 21C, etc.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
That's the Co-Op Fund. Everyone in the building makes monthly deposits. And Nik invests it for us.

SERA
And it's all legitimate?

VALERIE
I don't know much about finance.

SERA
Well if it's evidence of a crime...
...and Murry got ahold of it...

Valerie processes the implications. Big sympathetic breath.

VALERIE
Darling. Deep down, you must know: it wasn't Nik who killed Murry.
(gently)
Murry killed Murry.

PENTHOUSE B

Wendy reads the article on her phone in dismay:

WENDY
You're...DEAD?

DEATH OF UPTOWN DOORMAN AN APPARENT SUICIDE

MURRY
I didn't have a choice.

WENDY
You did! And it is an awful choice.

MURRY
Well it's made! All I can do now is make that choice right.

WENDY
(halting, horrified)
You like this.

MURRY
No, I'm just making the best--

WENDY
No. You want it.

MURRY
Is that so crazy?

Wendy nods. Yes!

SERA (PRE-LAP)
He wasn't crazy.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera shakes her head, tearing up. Valerie speaks more gently.

VALERIE
I know it's hard to accept. But after all you two went through...

Sera flinches. *What is she talking about?*

VALERIE (CONT'D)
It's okay. The police told me about the earthquake in Turkey. *You were just children*. And no one can keep that type of thing buried forever.

The ground seems to shake beneath Sera...

SERA
No. You don't get it. He was--

VALERIE
I'm talking about you.

...until Valerie CATCHES HER with a hand on the shoulder.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Watching your family disappear. I can't imagine what I'd do after such a thing. What *did* you do?

Sera doesn't speak. But Valerie is warm. Easy to confide in.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Sera. You can talk to me. What did you do after they disappeared?

SERA
I waited.

VALERIE
Why?

SERA
I could feel he was still there.

VALERIE
Is that how you feel now?

Sera slowly nods. Embarrassed. A tear forming in her eye.

VALERIE
And what does the rational part of your brain tell you when you think that thought?
(beat, eye to eye)
Your brother made a choice. And I get why you still wait for him. But miracles don't happen twice. And he's not climbing out this time.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry panics as Wendy grabs her bag.

MURRY
Please don't tell anyone.

WENDY
Why shouldn't I?

MURRY
Because you already told your boss.

She stops. He's right.

MURRY (CONT'D)
You really want to be the gullible associate who got hustled by some...*delusional con man?*

Wendy stiffens. Steps forward. Eye to eye.

WENDY
Who the fuck do you think you are?

MURRY
Let's not make this personal, Wendy. We can still do business--

WENDY
Business? What business? Do you have an LLC? Any IP applications? *Any* documentation with a name?

Murry slowly shakes his head. Looks down.

WENDY (CONT'D)
Good.

What. She sniffs around the fragrance box with displeasure.

WENDY
Keep it that way. And keep all your stinky juices. I don’t want anything connected to you.

Murry’s face folds. What.

WENDY (CONT'D)
It’s not personal. I was told to bring this concept back to Pearson, ideally without attachments.
(heading for door)
Maybe they’ll make me partner and I won’t have to work anymore.

He looks at the box. His colognes.

MURRY
But this is my life.

WENDY
That’s not what you just told me.

He looks around the penthouse. Time to make a choice.

MURRY
Fine. With my resources, I can start fifty new businesses.

WENDY
I don’t give a fuck what you do. You’re already dead to me.
(with spite)
Nik.

Wendy marches out and slams the door. Snacks whines.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera quickly wipes her eyes. Then unplugs the thumbdrive. Rises. But Valerie grabs her arm.

VALERIE
What will you do with that?

SERA
Figure out what it actually means and bring it to the police.

VALERIE
I'll bring it to them. They already think you're crazy.

Sera simmers. Valerie realizes she's still holding her arm. Releases her. Sera heads off.

Valerie sighs. Then grabs her phone. Dials 911.

VALERIE
Yes. There's a crazy woman here impersonating a police officer--

ELEVATOR

Wendy presses DOWN. As the doors close, Sera approaches...

Wendy reaches to hold the door, but--

SERA

stops. SNIFFS. Elevator doors close as she turns her head to:

PENTHOUSE B

where Valerie charges inside from the deck to find Murry.

VALERIE
We have a problem.

MURRY
I took care of it.

Valerie shakes her head. Nods to the door.

Murry steps over and checks the peephole. Sees:

SERA

on the other side. SNIFFING. Listening. Then--

RED/BLUE flashes through the window. She slips to the stairs.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - MINUTES LATER

Murry and Valerie look down at Sera jumping into her car and driving away...just before police arrive.

MURRY
I'm dead to her and she still can't let me live my life.

VALERIE
Settle down. She has evidence, but she doesn't know what it means.

MURRY
What *does* it mean?

VALERIE
That the Board was right about Nik. About the fund. He was faking trades and pocketing the money. I've seen it a million times. I thought I was smarter than this.

MURRY
What about his other clients?

VALERIE
Nikki. *We're* your only clients.

Murry falls back onto a deck chair. He's going down.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
This is good. We can contain it. We can make a deal with the Board. But only if we deal with those files.

But Murry's sinking. She touches his chest.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Listen. I know none of this is the "right" thing to do. But we can still *make it right*. Right?

MURRY
You listened to the podcast?

VALERIE
Of course. You recommended it. And now I have a recommendation for you. Get those documents.
(grabbing his chin)
Before she buries you with them.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - LATER

The <u>THUMBDRIVE</u> is plugged into Sera's laptop.

Next to a printer. Which prints documents by the ream.

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Look who's back from grandma's!

Husband and the Toddler walk in to find:

FINANCIAL DOCUMENTS covering the floor...

HUSBAND
What's uh...what's all this?

...and his wife pacing around them, manic.

SERA
Some type of scheme. I don't know the shape of it yet.
(inspecting document)
But I know there's a connection.

HUSBAND
To what?

SERA
To him. To Nik--

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

Murry hides in the bushes, watching the house.

SERA (V.O.)(CONT'D)
--fucking.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - SAME

Husband sighs.

HUSBAND
--Lamb.

SERA (CONT'D)
--Lamb.

Sera flinches. *How does he know that?*

HUSBAND
They just told me everything.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

From the bushes, Murry now sees a POLICE CAR in the driveway.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - SAME

Husband opens the door for the Detectives and asks:

HUSBAND
Can we have a few more minutes?

SERA
Sorry am I being arrested?

HUSBAND
No. No one's pressing charges.

DETECTIVE 2
But impersonating an officer is a very serious offense. We warned you, Sera.

SERA
(leading to living room)
I get it. I'm sorry. Really. But there's something you need to see.

LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Sera shows the Detectives the files on the floor. Look!

It looks insane. The Detectives aren't sure how to respond.

SERA
This was at the scene. On a USB drive with, guess what, Nik's initials. I'll show you.

She turns for her laptop but--

DETECTIVE 1
Sera. We have no reason to believe that device is in any way connected to your brother or his death.

SERA
But the woman next door--

DETECTIVE 1
Valerie Muller is the one who called us. She said she was scared. That she was telling you what you wanted to hear so you would leave.

SERA
Because she's working with him!

Detectives exchange a look with the Husband, concerned.

DETECTIVE 2
Just give it to her.

Sera squints. *Give me what?*

Detective 1 sighs. Hands her a BOX with her name on it.

DETECTIVE 1
We found this on the roof.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

Murry hears the cop car door SLAM. Watches them drive off. But the others are still inside the house. He needs to wait.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Husband finds Sera at the window. Box on the table.

HUSBAND
Do you want me to open it with you?

She doesn't respond.

HUSBAND
Listen. When people are suffering--

SERA
He wasn't suffering.

HUSBAND
I'm talking about you.

INSERT: BODY DROPPING IN THE REARVIEW MIRROR

HUSBAND (CONT'D)
I know you were there. I know you were following him. And I'm not mad. I'm just worried.

She turns away from him.

HUSBAND (CONT'D)
Sera. Please. This isn't even the first time you've seen him die.

The earth seems to SHAKE until he GRIPS HER in a hug.

SERA
I just want to know what happened.

HUSBAND
No. You don't.

Sera looks at the box. Toddler whines from the other room.

HUSBAND
Go be with her. She just lost her uncle.

LIVING ROOM

Sera walks in and finds her Toddler on the floor...

...playing with the documents! Making triangles and circles.

SERA
What are you doing!?

TODDLER
I'm making shapes mommy.

Sera YANKS her away. Then marches off. Leaving her crying daughter to her Husband. He sighs.

HUSBAND
Let's get your princess bag. We're going back to grandma's.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - NIGHT

It's getting dark. Murry hears the family piling in a car. Then sees it drive away. Coast is clear. He creeps toward the house. Cracks a basement window...

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BATHROOM - SAME

But Sera's still inside. Lying in the tub, shower on.

BASEMENT

Murry searches. Looking for the thumbdrive. Nothing down here. He heads for the steps, but hears a KNOCK upstairs.

THE FRONT DOOR

is cracked open. Fatma Teyze is KNOCKING. Halva dessert in hand. She peeks her head inside. Shouts in Turkish.

No one responds. But she hears the shower. Steps inside.

BASEMENT

Murry hears the floor CREAK above him. Shit.

He looks for an escape. But the windows are too high. So he sneaks under the stairs but the--

FLOORBOARD BREAKS and his foot drops through a hole.

He tries to yank it out. But cuts his ankle on jagged wood.

He's stuck.

KITCHEN

Fatma, making coffee, hears the noise downstairs.

BASEMENT

Murry panics as a DOOR OPENS above him.

Fatma steps down...

...but passes over his head. Phew. But--

FATMA
You shouldn't be here. This isn't your life anymore.

She turns and looks him right in the eyes.

KITCHEN

Sera, hearing the commotion, enters in a towel. Listens by the door to the basement. Hears someone coming upstairs...

...and PINS FATMA to the wall.

FATMA
There you are. I was making coffee when I heard your brother down there. Silly boy is stuck again. He's waiting for you to let him go.

SERA
Get the fuck out of my house.

Sera stares at her until she understands the message.

Fatma heads out. Sera SLAMS the basement door closed.

BASEMENT

Murry, still trapped, exhales at the sound.

But then the door suddenly OPENS AGAIN--

Sera marches over Murry's head. Looks around. Breathes heavy. She feels stupid for even checking.

SERA
I am crazy.

BENEATH HER FEET: Murry covers his mouth.

He holds his breath until...he hears her walk away.

Door closes. He exhales. Then works on his stuck foot.

LIVING ROOM

Above him, Sera walks across the insane mess of documents.

Finally, she opens the box. Inside: perfume. And a note.

She SPRITZES the perfume. She watches the mist drift down...

...then her body drifts down to the floor.

After a bit, she finally reads Murry's suicide note.

Meanwhile, out the window above her:

MURRY DRAGS his wounded foot across the backyard.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - AN HOUR LATER

Murry limps inside. Blood on his sock.

Snacks WHINES. But Murry doesn't have the energy to pet him. Just looks at the fragrance box. Selects a bottle. Spritzes. Watches the mist drift down. Falls back onto the sofa.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM

Sera peels herself off the floor. Starts cleaning up the documents. Restoring order...

...until noticing the triangle shapes her daughter made. Hm.

She stops. Steps back. Looks down at them.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

Murry's asleep on the sofa when he hears--

BARKING

He sits up. Looks for Snacks. Then finds:

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
Welcome home...*Murphy*.

Cynthia, head still bandaged, pets Snacks on her lap.

Uh oh.

THROUGH THE WINDOW

Valerie spies from the deck. Pulls out her phone.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - SAME

BUZZING on Sera's phone.

But she's busy. Locked in.

Reorganizing files. Arranging by account and deposit history.

Finally, she answers without looking. Waits.

VALERIE (PHONE)
Sera. Please don't hang up.
(beat)
I'm sorry I called the police. I was protecting myself. This is a very dangerous situation.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Valerie peers through glass at:

Cynthia looming over Murry.

SERA (PHONE)
I know. I can see it now.

VALERIE
See what, dear?

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - SAME

Sera's standing on the sofa. Breathless.

Looking down at the documents arranged on the floor.

FOUR: **PYRAMID**

Pharaoh LLC

20B 20D 21C 21F 21G

16C 16F 17A 18B 18E 19A 19D

12A 12C 12E 14B 14C 14E 15A 15D 15F

4H 5D 6A 6C 7B 7F 9A 9F 10B 10D 10E 11C 11D

SERA (CONT'D)
The real shape of things.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Valerie listens to Sera on the phone. Nervous.

SERA (PHONE) (CONT'D)
It's a ponzi scheme. Your Co-Op fund. Everything you've given him...it goes right to the top. To his account. Pharaoh LLC.

VALERIE
Then we need to get that evidence to our attorneys immediately.

SERA (PHONE)
Not until I figure out what it has to do with Murry.

VALERIE
Sera. Bring me those documents, and I'll show you exactly what this has to do with Murry.

Valerie looks back through the glass: Murry's terrified face.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Cynthia reveals a casserole for Murry, hot on the table.

MURRY
I'm...I'm not hungry.

CYNTHIA
Oh, dear. You look worse than I do.
(touching her bandage)
If you don't eat, I'll have to call 911 and get you to the hospital.

He glances at the wall with Penthouse A.

CYNTHIA
Oh she can’t help you now.

He turns back--

SHE JAMS A FORKFUL of casserole in his mouth.

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Tonight, you answer to us.

The door opens for:

Larry and Rhonda, who look sweetly at Murry.

RHONDA
Sorry we’re late. I picked up some wraps. Are you hungry?

CYNTHIA
I hope so. He has more to swallow.

INT./EXT. SERA’S CAR - NIGHT

Sera drives toward Manhattan’s skyline. Phone dying. On the passenger seat: the stack of documents.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

Rhonda pulls out the wraps. Larry is not impressed. On the sofa, Murry leans over to whisper to Cynthia.

MURRY
Do they know about me?

CYNTHIA
That you murdered a tenant? Or that you’ve been impersonating him?

She seems to be enjoying this! But she reels it in.

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Relax. Rhonda lobotomized herself with facebook and Larry only cares about sex. They won’t say a word unless they’re told to.

MURRY
Then tell me what you want from me.

Cynthia sets a thick legal document in front of Murry.

CYNTHIA
Accountability.

Phrases like DEFRAUDING INVESTORS and FINANCIAL RESTITUTION and UP-TO-AND-INCLUDING INCARCERATION.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Sera parks in front of the Pyramid. Takes out the thumbdrive.

Thinks. Finds a fruit rollup. Wraps the thumbdrive in the fruit rollup, then the wrapper. Shoves it back in her tote.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - MINUTES LATER

Valerie opens the door for Sera. Checks both ways.

VALERIE
Where are the documents?

SERA
In my car. But the detectives, I told you, they don't care.

VALERIE
They don't know what they're looking at. But I can explain everything to them.

SERA
Why didn't you explain earlier?

VALERIE
You know why. I'm terrified of him. But now we have each other.

Valerie takes her hands. It puts Sera at ease.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
I'll come with you.

Valerie opens the door and heads out for the elevator.

Sera follows until she--

Stops. SNIFFS.

Turns to a bottle of perfume on the mantle. From her pocket, Sera pulls out the bottle Murry left her.

It's the same bottle.

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

Valerie presses DOWN. Looks back to Sera, who's still inside.

VALERIE
Come on.

Elevator arrives with a DING. Triggering--

BARKING

Sera pokes her head out and looks at Penthouse B.

SERA
Is that him?

VALERIE
(whispering, impatient)
No. He's not home.

SERA
(loud whisper)
Then why are you whispering?

Eye contact. Uh oh. Sera SLAMS the door closed. LOCK.

Valerie races back to her locked door as--

Cynthia and Rhonda pour out to see what the commotion is.

VALERIE
Cynthia! The door!

PENTHOUSE B

Murry SLAMS the door from inside and LOCKS it. Looks back at Larry in his chair. Harmless. Then finds the master key. No one's getting in now.

BANG BANG BANG from the front door...

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
Let us in or we call the cops!

...and BANG BANG BANG from the glass door to the deck.

SERA (O.S.)
Nik Lamb! Let me in or I'm calling the police!

He looks back and forth at the doors. He's trapped. Until--

A CONCRETE PLANTER CRASHES through the window.

Sera CHARGES through the broken glass.

But Murry GRABS her from behind and covers her mouth. Spins her away from the mirrors so she doesn't see his face.

Sera drops her tote bag as she tries to strike him.

Snacks tries to jump at her and defend Murry. But he can't see! He's just lunging and biting the air.

LARRY

wheels to front door. Stretches to unlock it. Too high!

MURRY AND SERA

struggle as he tries to evade her gaze without hurting her.

Sera ELBOWS his stomach. But before she can see his face--

Snacks manages to scratch her leg, distracting her.

Murry runs out onto the deck. Sera chases after...

...leaving Snacks with the tote-bag. Uh oh. He SNIFFS his way to the fruit rollup with the thumbdrive. Gobbles it up.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Sera stalks Murry onto the deck. Shard of glass in her hand as she searches...

SERA
Nikos...I just want to talk.

MURRY

hides behind the hedges on Valerie's side of the deck.

SERA (O.S.)
What happened to my brother?

Finally, in the REFLECTION of the WINDOW, he sees:

SERA approaching behind him.

SERA
Say something!

He looks up in the reflection. Eye contact.

MURRY
Please don’t be mad.

SERA SCREAMS!

Drops the glass shard. Steps back. Hands over her mouth.

SERA
You’re dead. I watched you die.

MURRY
Not now. Just get to Valerie’s while I deal with the Board.

Murry races off. Sera’s stuck in place.

SERA
But I don’t trust her.

MURRY (O.S.)
Then trust me!

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Larry stretches long enough to unlock the front door.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera returns through the open door. Calls back outside:

SERA
Hurry up!
(head back through door)
Murry--

VALERIE (O.S.)
His name is Nik.

Valerie drives the dog’s insulin NEEDLE into her neck. She whispers in Sera’s ear as blood sugar crashes...

VALERIE (CONT'D)
And I’m finished sharing him.

...then lets Sera crash to the floor.

MINUTES LATER

Murry races in to find Valerie tending to unconscious Sera.

VALERIE
Cynthia must've stuck her with the dog insulin. What happened in there?

MURRY
They know about me. And Nik.

VALERIE
Then we need to get that evidence before they do. Where are her keys?

PENTHOUSE B - A MINUTE LATER

Cynthia slowly opens the door--

VALERIE SLAMS THROUGH IT, knocking Cynthia to floor.

VALERIE
Find me the car keys.

Valerie grabs the cane before it falls.

CYNTHIA
He didn't sign yet.

VALERIE
I know that, you insect.
(pressing cane to Cynthia)
That's why we need to destroy those documents immediately. Until he takes responsibility, Pharaoh is still in our name.

RHONDA
...*your* name, technically.

Valerie SMACKS Rhonda with the cane. OW.

VALERIE
This is a co-operative, Rhonda. We need to cooperate. If I go down, I'm dragging you with me.

On the floor, Cynthia scowls.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera's eyes flutter open. Above her:

HER BROTHER.

She tries to scream. But she has no energy. Just squeaks out:

SERA
What did you do?

CREAK.

Murry swings to the deck door. Puts his fingers to his lips. Tiptoes to the door to check outside...

...but that's not where the sound came from...

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT

Murry carefully approaches Penthouse B. Waits beside the glass door to watch the shadows. Then peeks inside. Sees:

Cynthia and Rhonda tear through cushions and drawers, hunting for the car keys. Larry supervises. No Valerie.

Just then, he hears--

SERA YELLING.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - NIGHT

Murry races back in and finds:

Sera's hands, legs, and mouth taped up. She's going nuts. Mumbling indecipherably--

MURRY
Who did this?

SERA
(mumbling through tape)
Pharaoh!

AN INSULIN NEEDLE STICKS Murry in the neck--

VALERIE (O.S.)
It's nothing personal, Nikki.

Valerie catches him in her arms from behind. Eye contact as she lets his body drop to the floor.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
It's just Manhattan.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Murry WAKES UP in Nik's bedroom. *Was that a dream?*

SERA (O.S.)
Murry.

No. Sera sits on the floor, back against the wall. Wrists raw from tape. They've been in there a while.

He peels himself off the bed, tries the door--

SERA
They have it barricaded.

MURRY
There must be a way out--

SERA
There's no way out. Not now.

He looks at the king bed. His palace now a prison.

MURRY
Because of you.

Eye contact. *Excuse me?*

MURRY (CONT'D)
Two weeks ago, I was opening doors.

SERA
Two weeks ago, you were alive.

MURRY
In the basement.
(huffing on side of bed)
Where you could look down on me.

SERA
At least I was looking. Why do you think I was here to see you fall? *Again*. I came for you. And found your body at my fucking feet.

Her mouth goes dry.

SERA (CONT'D)
You wrote me a suicide note.

MURRY
Would you rather me be a murderer?

SERA
I'd rather you be alive.

MURRY
I am alive.

SERA
Not to me. Not like this. My brother wouldn't kill a man.

MURRY
He was a bad person, Sera.

SERA
And what does that make you?

VALERIE (O.S.)
Nikki?

KNOCK KNOCK

VALERIE (O.S.)(CONT'D)
Let's get these documents signed so we can all go to dinner.

SERA
Don't do this. She *is* Pharaoh. The files incriminate her, not Nik. He stole them so he could escape.

But he knows already. She pushes harder:

SERA (CONT'D)
You don't have to live with his mistake.

They hear furniture SLIDE away from the door.

MURRY
It's my mistake now.

Door opens. Valerie pokes her head in.

VALERIE
Nik.

SERA
That's not his name.

VALERIE
Oh. Nik isn't a person, darling.
(smiling to Murry)
Nik is a job. A job at which he's been doing quite well since his predecessor resigned.
(gesturing to follow)
Let's go. The Board is waiting.

She turns back to Sera and FLICKS the insulin needle.

VALERIE
Unless you'd like to go back down.

LIVING ROOM

The Co-Op Board is gathered before a roaring fireplace. Sera's documents curl and blacken in the flames.

Valerie marches Murry and Sera to the sofa.

VALERIE
I apologize for the theatrics. Consider it...*risk management*.

Valerie stands behind Sera, needle to her neck.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Now, I understand our dispute seems intractable. But this board always finds a compromise.

SERA
The compromise is he goes to prison for you.

VALERIE
Prison? Don't be absurd. This is the Upper East Side. Nik has excellent attorneys. Worst case he's looking at six months in Camp Cupcake playing bocce with Madoff. Then back home. To all this.

She gestures around the penthouse. Murry's eyes follow.

SERA
Well he won't do it.

VALERIE
Yes. He will.

SERA
No he won't--

MURRY
I will.

Sera turns to Murry. What. Valerie hands him the pen.

SERA
Murry--

MURRY
My name is Nik.

Murry signs the document. *NIKOS C. LAMB.*

SERA
You fucking idiot. Those documents would have cleared you.

VALERIE
I don't see any documents.

Larry's going nuts.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Larry settle down.

CYNTHIA
No. Let him talk.

RHONDA
He can't!

But he *can* point. And he slowly lifts his finger to...

Snacks, who BARKS. Sticky redness on his mouth.

VALERIE
Larry. Did the dog eat the evidence?

Larry stares at the guilty dog. Yes!!!

MURRY
No.

VALERIE
We're going to need that back.

Valerie homes in on Snacks...who can't see her coming.

MURRY
Snacks, run!

Confused and panicked, Snacks can smell Valerie closing in.

He runs off, bumping into walls...then finding his way through the broken window.

VALERIE
Get him Rhonda! Or it'll be you in Larry's chair.

Rhonda hurries after. Valerie hands Cynthia the needle then follows her onto the deck.

Murry tries to stand but--

Cynthia points the needle into Sera's cheek.

CYNTHIA
Sit.

Murry sits. Then looks at Sera, who turns away.

He SNIFFS.

MURRY
Sera. Is that what I think it is?

SERA
What?

MURRY
Abla. Parfüm var mı?

She cocks her head. How does he know--

MURRY (CONT'D)
I made it for my sister.

SERA
I didn't know Nik had a sister.

MURRY
Yeah. She's a fucking psycho. A control freak who always tells him what to do. But god forbid anyone ever tells *her* what to do! She'd rather <u>set the room on fire</u> than be constrained in any way!

CYNTHIA
Can you two be quiet?

Sera discreetly pulls the <u>perfume</u> from her pocket.

MURRY
Do you even like it?

SERA
It smells like garbage.

Sera drops the bottle. It tumbles in front of her feet...

...she KICKS it into the fire.

CYNTHIA
What did you just do?

But nothing happens. Murry and Sera exchange a look. Failure.

SERA
Nothing.

MURRY
No, Sera. You were right.

The perfume bottle starts melting...

MURRY (CONT'D)
It’s cheap plastic bullshit.

...leaking flammable liquid drips into the embers...

The fireplace SPRAYS FIRE!

Cynthia DROPS the needle.

Before she reaches for it, she sees the fire. Then Murry and Sera. Puts her hands up. Steps back.

MURRY
Let’s go!

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Murry races out. Smoke following him.

MURRY
Where is he?

Sera stumbles out after him, coughing. The deck is dark. Broken glass from the planter everywhere.

She takes a wrong step and her foot catches the base of the rusty railing. She falls sideways--

For a moment she's hanging over 22 stories of nothing.

--until Murry GRABS HER ARM.

MURRY
Don’t look down.

He yanks her back up. She steadies.

SERA
Just go.

Murry clears the smoke and finds:

Valerie holding Snacks by the railing. SQUEEZING him.

MURRY
Put him down.

VALERIE
When I'm finished. He still has something that belongs to me.
(to Snacks)
Don't make me cut it out of you.

Snacks VOMITS in her face.

Valerie DROPS the dog.

Then drops to her knees to look for the thumbdrive.

But Murry scoops it up.

VALERIE
Give it to me, Nikki.

Murry doesn't budge.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
I'll make it all worth it. I promise. I know we've made bad choices. But all we can do now is make those choices right. Right?

MURRY
You're right.

Oh thank god! She rushes in to hug him.

MURRY (CONT'D)
And I know it's not personal.

Valerie exhales. It never was! But--

MURRY (CONT'D)
It's just Manhattan.

He pushes her back--

She trips backward over the disoriented Snacks--

Falls into the rusty railing--

But the railing holds...

...for a moment of eye contact.

She reaches for his hand--

HINGES SNAP!

Murry scoops Snacks into his arms as--

Valerie drops backward over the edge...

...plummets 22 stories...

...and SPLATS on the asphalt.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)
Mayhem at the Pyramid House uptown Monday after the suicide of Co-Op Board Co-President, Valerie Muller.

EXT. STREET - A LITTLE LATER

SIRENS BLARE as Sera stumbles out of the back exit.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
Board Members report confronting Ms. Muller with evidence of a multi-year financial conspiracy, after which she set fire to a neighbor's apartment and took her own life.

Disoriented, she finds her car.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
Authorities now indicate a connection with the death of doorman Murat Oğan.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - DAYS LATER

REVEAL the LOCAL NEWS on YouTube on a phone.

LOCAL NEWS (ON PHONE)(CONT'D)
In an exclusive interview, new Board President Cynthia Wax tells Channel 6 how Ms. Muller ruled the Pyramid with an iron fist. Using the Co-Op investment fund as a personal piggy bank while blackmailing neighbor Nik Lamb into accepting liability for the entire scheme.

Cynthia appears in the shot.

CYNTHIA (ON PHONE)
Nikki didn't do anything wrong. He was scared of her. We all were. Maybe if we were braver, Murry would still be alive.

Sera parks in front of the Pyramid.

LOCAL NEWS (ON PHONE)
Multiple tenants now say Ms. Muller's reign of terror prevented them from coming forward earlier with the truth: that she pushed the 24-year-old off her penthouse deck after being confronted with evidence of her crimes.

She looks out the window. Up at the building.

To the top.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Murry looks down at Sera.

LOCAL NEWS (V.O.)(CONT'D)
Mr. Lamb, meanwhile, plans to settle with the victims and the SEC for an undisclosed amount, and is expected to avoid criminal charges.

Then watches her drive away.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - CONTINUOUS

Snacks BARKS!

Murry walks back inside.

He looks around the penthouse.

LOCAL NEWS (V.O.)(CONT'D)
He could not be reached for comment.

Closes the glass door behind him.

In the reflection, he sees Nik.

Nik smiles.

